

Sony MDR-MV1

Sonic bliss with a single grain of salt

In the last few months, a few wired headphones have shown up at the Digit Test Centre. All of them have their ups and downs, but there are a few that have impressed everyone around here as the Sony MDR-MV1 headphones. These studio headphones stand out from the crowd with their excellent build, design, comfort, and performance, acing all the tests that we ran on them. There are some areas where there could have been certain improvements made to the Sony MDR-MV1. But the pros here outweigh the cons, and that too by a long, long shot.

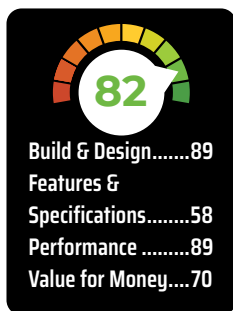
Given that these headphones slot in at a spot that only the purists/professionals look into, evaluating them from that perspective is also something that was very interesting for us. And when you factor in the beefy price tag of ₹39,990, things get even more interesting for these headphones. Having said that, putting it through its paces was a fun experience, and the robust test process that we have in place ensured that the headphones were pushed to their limits.

Now, without wasting much time and giving you spoilers about the performance of these headphones, let's dive into my review of the Sony MDR MV1 headphones –

BUILD AND DESIGN

When I put on these headphones, only one thing came into my mind – “Damn, these are comfortable”. Weighing in at around 223 grams without the cable and slightly more with it, the Sony MDR-MV1 headphones are some of the lightest pairs of headphones that I have tested here at Digit. During my time testing these headphones, I would wear them throughout my workday without experiencing any form of discomfort.

₹39,990



The reason I feel that Sony has been able to keep the weight of these headphones down is that they did not need to pack in additional tech to ensure that the drivers sound awesome. The drivers have been tuned almost to perfection, and the efforts of the development team not only show in the performance but also in the weight and overall feel of the headphones.

I have prescription glasses, and my head size is slightly on the larger side. But neither of these things, which generally affect my usage experience negatively, came into play with the Sony MDR-MV1 headphones. When you would look at the headphones, you will feel that the headband, for instance, is not padded enough. But the padding that these headphones have, coupled with their weight, ensures that the robust metal headband does not dig into your skull. The memory foam padding on the earcups also adds to the experience of using these headphones. We

have seen in the past that memory foam and the faux leather that has been used in the headband degrade over time, but with proper care, it should last a while.

The swivel on the earcups ensures that these sit flush and prevent a LOT of sound leaks which is inevitable, given the open-back nature of these headphones. It also ensures that the drivers are also positioned in a way in which they deliver sound in the most optimal way possible to your ears.

As for the materials, there is quality all around. The metallic headband, backed by a plastic lining, let me twist and turn these headphones all that I wanted. The shell of the earcups, which is also metallic, adds to the durability of the headphones. The slits in the casing might catch some gunk over time, but you can brush it off easily. The branding on these headphones is present but subtle.

The 3.5 mm connector, the cable, and the 3.5 mm to quarter-inch adapter also carry the same premium build and feel as the rest of the headphones. The attachment point of the cable on the earcups has been threaded to allow the 3.5 mm jack to be held in place by a screw-on casing that is there around it. And the metallic casing on the other end, which has the quarter-inch jack, is also metallic, with both the jacks being gold plated.

The 2.5-metre cable, which is the longest I've seen in a while, has a thick rubberised outer layer shielding the inner wires. The presence of braiding on the cable also ensures that it is tangle resistant, which means that when you are on the go, you will not be held up untangling the cable once you pull these out of your backpack.

While on the topic of travelling, don't expect these headphones to fold into a small package that you can stuff in your backpack. As is the case with almost every other professional-grade headphone meant for use in a studio space, the Sony MDR-MV1 do not fold much. The most you can do is fold the earcups to make them flat, but that's about it. So, I would recommend that you get yourself a nice hard case if you plan to travel with these headphones.